

CHANDIGARH | Anandpur Sahib Redux

After rubbing the BJP the wrong way by elevating his son Sukhbir Singh Badal to the chair of deputy chief minister, Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal has raked up the controversial Anandpur Sahib Resolution and made it a key talking point before the Lok Sabha elections. This has irked the BJP even more as the resolution fanned a violent separatist movement in Punjab in the 1980s. The Badals are pushing for the resolution to be included in the NDA's manifesto despite L.K. Advani rejecting it as "separatist" in his biography, *My Country, My Life*.

Dusting off the resolution is part of the Badals' shrewd move to buttress their panthic credentials and dent anti-incumbency as well as consolidate the Sikh vote bank. Radical Akali factions will pose a



PARKASH AND SUKHBIR SINGH BADAL

challenge to Badals' Shiromani Akali Dal as will the running animosity with religious group Dera Sacha Sauda, which had swung in favour of the Congress in the 2007 Assembly elections. Clearly, the SAD-BJP in alliance in Punjab has another hot potato on their hands.

by Ramesh Vinayak

First Sight

While the prime minister may not make it for the Vote on Account that will be presented by Pranab Mukherjee, PMO officials say that Manmohan Singh plans to be in Parliament on the last day of this session which is expected to be the last of the 14th Lok Sabha.



GIRDHARI LAL SARANGI

BHUBANESWAR | Old Versus New

The Congress may believe that K.P. Singhdeo can take on Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik in the Assembly and Lok Sabha polls, but it seems to have forgotten that it's a tough task for a newcomer to work wonders in just two months. The Congress high command has appointed three working presidents in the state to help Singhdeo—Union Minister of State for Rural Development Chandrasekhar Sahu, former Union minister Bhakta Charan Das and MLA Lalatendu Bidyadhar Mohapatra. Singhdeo replaced Jaydev Jena as PCC chief as he was seen as an inactive leader.

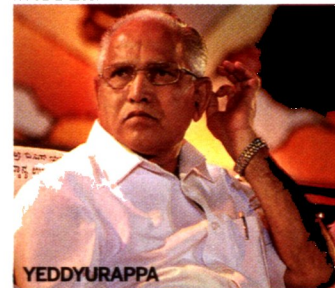
by Farzand Ahmed

BANGALORE |

Twist in the Tale

Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa, his three children and two servants have been accused of causing the death of his wife Maithradevi, who drowned in four feet of water in a

HK RAJASHEKAR



YEDDYURAPPA

tank outside her house in Shimoga in 2004. A petition filed in a local court charges them with murder and fabrication of evidence. While stories of 'other women' breaking up first families are nothing new in south India, given the legacy of former chief ministers like M.G. Ramachandran, M. Karunanidhi, N.T. Rama Rao and Ramakrishna Hegde, the accusation of murder is a new twist in the tale.

by Nirmala Ravindran